

Chapter 171-2

After a day, Liang Xinran appeared to have become quite familiar with Yang Shuyan, but Yang Shuyan maintained her lukewarm demeanor throughout.

There was none of the intimacy she showed when interacting with Bai Yu.

When dinner time came, after they finished eating, they played another game—the classic "Visit Three Gardens."¹

Liang Xinran kept losing in various unexpected places.

In the end, her face was covered with sticky notes, yet she still said to the camera with a smile: "How did this happen?"

The following days were much the same.

Liang Xinran didn't deliberately provoke Liang Shi, but occasionally they would clash in subtle ways—for instance, when competing for tasks or forming teams, Liang Xinran would smile sweetly at her: "A-Shi wants to compete with me again?"

Liang Shi would always yield to her, because she couldn't be bothered to argue with her.

But when it came to matters of winning or losing, Liang Shi wouldn't give an inch.

The production team staff privately nicknamed them "The Battle of the Two Liangs."

Liang Shi didn't take it to heart. She just wanted to finish filming this show as soon as possible.

She really didn't want to see Liang Xinran.

What made Liang Shi particularly uncomfortable was on the evening before the last day of recording.

That day, the tasks ended earlier than usual. Because she and Yang Shuyan were about to leave, the production team had prepared a lavish dinner.

After the tasks ended, everyone had to go get their hair and makeup done. Liang Shi hadn't even brought a styling team—she did everything herself. So she simply braided her hair and did a light, natural makeup look, very much like those "first love" makeup looks popular online.

After finishing her styling, she went to the bathroom. When she came out, she saw Liang Xinran smoking.

Expressionless, her eyes cold, she was exhaling smoke without a trace of emotion. That delicate face carried a hint of world-weariness—different from Zhou Yi'an and Chen Mian's kind. It was a world-weariness tinged with shadow, the corner of her lips slightly curved in faint mockery.

She clearly hadn't said anything yet, but it already made people feel uncomfortable.

Liang Shi went to wash her hands, then dried them at a leisurely pace, completely ignoring her.

Then Liang Xinran stubbed out her cigarette and spoke, her voice somewhat hoarse: "Is it fun to ostracize me?"

Liang Shi's hand-drying motion paused. "What makes you say that?"

"Everyone can see that you don't like me." Liang Xinran's voice dropped lower. "I don't even know what I did. I've been trying to avoid you."

"That's not the case." Liang Shi's tone was cold, distant in every way. "You're overthinking it."

Liang Xinran lowered her eyes. "I know none of you like me. I'm not here to compete with you either. I know I can't compete with you—Big Brother and Second Brother both like you so much."

When she said this, she had no expression, but her voice was full of disappointment.

Liang Shi frowned slightly, sensing something was off. She looked around but didn't see any recording equipment.

Logically, this should be a break period—the staff had all gone to rest, so it shouldn't be a recording.

But if it wasn't being recorded, Liang Xinran's words were too strange.

So Liang Shi raised her guard and said coldly, "I don't know what you're talking about."

"How could you not know?" Liang Xinran laughed softly. "It's just the two of us here. I told Mom that I wanted you to come back, but you seem to have blocked her. Mom was quite hurt. She was sick before, and you didn't come either."

"She probably doesn't want to see me," Liang Shi replied.

"How could that be?" Liang Xinran said. "You two were the ones who lived together for over twenty years. I was just always away. Mom is only good to me because she feels guilty. But she genuinely likes you—otherwise, she wouldn't have always been so good to you. I'm not living at the old mansion now either. If you really don't like it, I can step aside."

"I don't dislike you," Liang Shi said. "Don't overthink it. There shouldn't be any competition between us."

"That's good then." Liang Xinran smiled bitterly. "I thought you had always disliked me."

"Why would you think that?" Liang Shi asked in return.

Liang Xinran paused. "It's just the feeling you give me. You seem to really dislike me—you never look at me when you talk. It's just intuition, I guess. I've always wanted to talk to you, but you..."

"Never mind." Liang Xinran's voice was bitter. "I only entered the entertainment industry to do something I like. I won't compete with you for anything. You don't need to hate me so much."

Liang Shi frowned but didn't deny that she disliked her. She turned and left.

The last day of recording was uneventful.

Footnotes:

¹ **"Visit Three Gardens" (逛三園):** A popular Chinese word association game often played in variety shows. Players take turns naming items that belong to a specific category (like fruits, vegetables, or animals in different "gardens"). Players who hesitate too long or give wrong answers lose and usually face a penalty like having sticky notes stuck to their face.